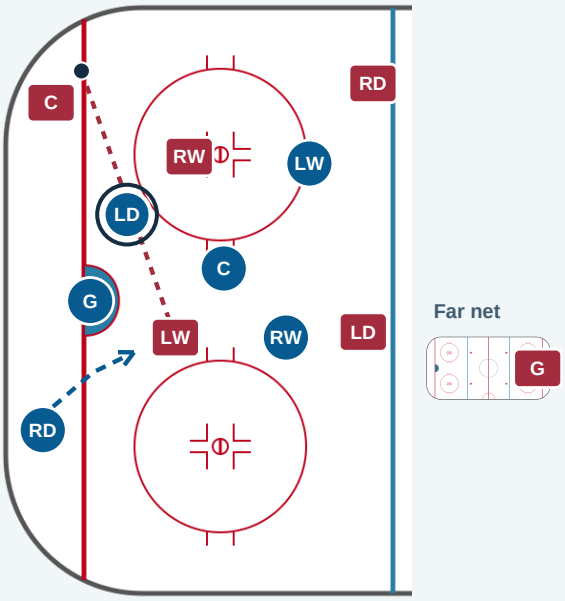
Defensive-zone shift blueprint

DRAFT FOR COACH REVIEW

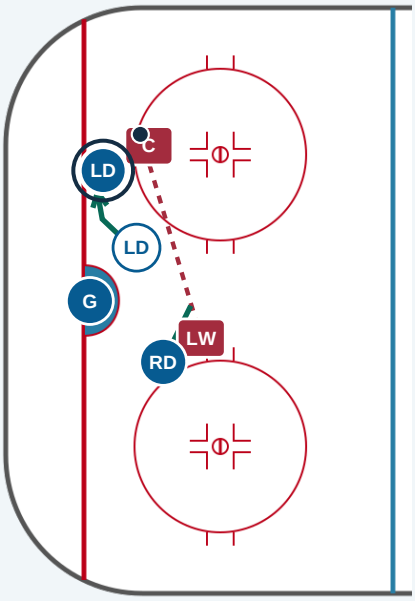
Marked upper corner | Blue defends left | Nov 11, 2026

01 START / HOLD THE LANE



Dashed blue shows RD returning. Dashed red shows the pass to LW. Red G starts at the far net.

02 HANDOFF / CONTAIN



Illustrative snapshot. Green arrow shows LD closing. Green stick line shows RD guarding the feed.

Key Blue circles defend. Red squares attack. Ring = your LD. Hollow LD = hold position. Dot = puck.

Blue starts LD guards the slot feed. RD starts behind the goal line on the lower side. C supports inside. LW shades the puck-side point. RW tucks toward the high slot. G protects the crease.

Red starts C carries from the upper corner. LW threatens net front. RW offers support in the upper circle. RD and LD are point outlets. G stays at the far crease.

Hold until RD owns the lane

Read puck, Red LW and RD. Stay goal-side in the feed lane while RD returns. RD is set when they are between LW and the goal, facing the play, with stick reach to deny the feed and coverage that holds. Hold if RD is late or on the wrong side. Leaving early gives Red C a direct pass to LW near the crease.

Close from inside

When RD is set and Red C still controls the puck on your side, skate out under control from the middle. Stay inside the carrier and keep the slot pass within stick reach. Recover inside if RD loses coverage. In Guided, look for **“RD has net front. Close from inside to contain.”**

ASSESS BOTH READS IN A SAME-SEED RETRY

Hold Compare holding the lane with leaving early. A sustained opening before RD takes over can give Red the slot feed and count as a miss, even if the pass is broken up or saved.

Contain Compare one continuous second of valid inside pressure with an interrupted or outside close. Record unobserved when play ends before a fair chance. Repeat mirrored and with RD late or wrong-side.

Guided pauses once before the handoff. Freer keeps play moving. Follow a loose puck until someone controls it.

Coach review Confirm the starting spacing, RD’s coverage picture and C/wing support. David’s Nov 11 approval of Hold and Contain scoring is recorded separately in the project handoff notes.